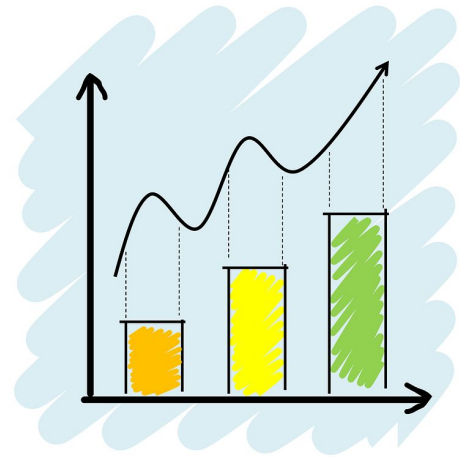


Lesson 17: From numbers to charts

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26



Slide contents based on Gene Zelazny's (2001) *Say It With Charts* (4th edition, McGraw-Hill)

Today's learning objective

**Identify a message from data
and create a table and a chart**

This and next week

This week

- Lesson 17: Choose and use charts
- Lesson 18: Rewriting practice about your data + Peer feedback

How was your data collection going?

What daily activity did you choose for the project?

How many days did you collect the data?

Is there another set of data or number you can compare yours with?
(e.g., average people's records, recommended quantity per day)

Do you remember the contexts of each day?

Step 1. Numbers into a table

The first step to organize your data is to create a table. Topmost rows and leftmost columns are used to show highly relevant categories/labels.

It is your job to find what other pieces of context can be informative to explain your numbers.



Sample table

I collected the data of my meal intake between February 5 and 25, for a total of thirteen days.

Days/ Dates	Wed	Thu	Fri	Mon	Tue	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Mon	Tue
Meals	Mar 18	19	20	23	24	26	27	28	29	30	31
Breakfast	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Lunch	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Snack	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
Dinner	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Night snack	No	No	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	No	Yes	No	Yes
Notes			I was sick.	Friend's BDay	Slept in; Dinner (Kudasan)		Club meet		Dinner delivery on Swiggy		Slept all morning

Step 2. Make a story from what your numbers tell

2-1 Complete the table and revise labels/categories if needed.

- Is there a new category or label you would like to add?
- Do you have a context or events that will be useful to interpret/explain some numbers?

2-2 Find a focus of your message.

- Are there any notable patterns? What are they?
- Which (aspect of) pattern do you want to focus on in your message?
Why is it worth looking at?

Determining the message

Capture noticeable patterns or parts that stand out.

Number of Sales by Size of Sale, May

Size of sale	Number of sales
<\$1,000	15
1,000-1,999	30
2,000-2,999	12
3,000-3,999	8
4,000 +	5

In May, most sales were in the \$1,000 to \$2,000 range.

Relationship of Salesperson's Experience to Sales

Sales-person	Years of experience	Amount of sales
P	2	\$23,000
Q	5	6,000
R	7	17,000
S	15	9,000
T	22	12,000

There is no relationship between sales and experience.

Choice of pattern

Sales by Product, \$000				
	Product			Total
	A	B	C	
Jan.	88	26	7	121
Feb.	94	30	8	132
Mar.	103	36	8	147
Apr.	113	39	7	159
May	122	40	13	175

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	Product			Total
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May	122	40	13	175
	70%	23%	7%	100%

At times, your attention determines a certain direction to be a highlighted message.

What messages can you come up with in these cases?

Pair activity

Work in a pair; take 6 minutes per person to show the data, create a table, and determine the message.

1. Open the recorded data. Briefly introduce the type of data and how it was collected.
2. Create a Google sheet file or a table in a Google doc file.
 - a. Transfer the numbers into the table
 - b. Add necessary and useful labels and categories
3. Find noticeable numbers or patterns
 - a. In what sense is it interesting?
 - b. Can we determine a message based on them? What is it?

Debrief

Which step took the most time?

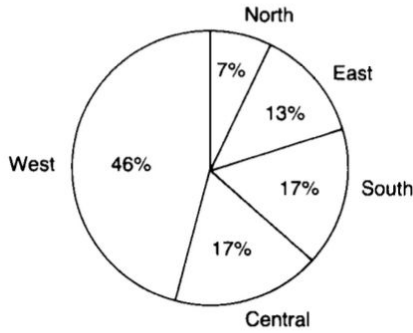
Was it easy or difficult to find relevant labels, categories, and contexts? Why?

What message did you come across?

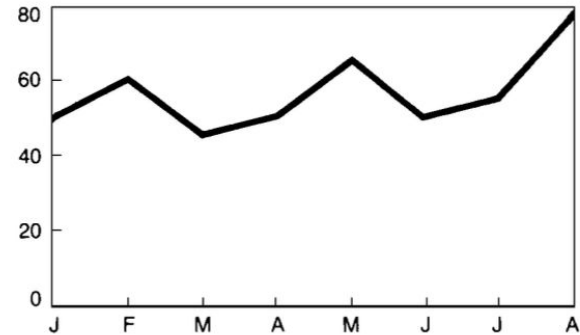
Intended message from table

Writers make a deliberate choice of chart type, to effectively send the message. At times, the message appears as a subtitle under the chart title for clarification. Let's provide a relevant subtitle for these charts.

SHARE OF PROFITS, BY REGION



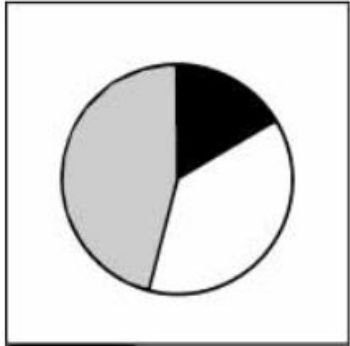
NUMBER OF CONTRACTS
January-August



Step 2 is crucial because

The chart /graph you will choose will be based on your main message.

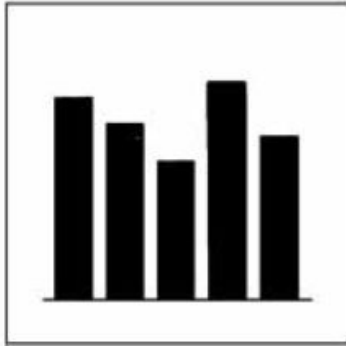
The pie chart



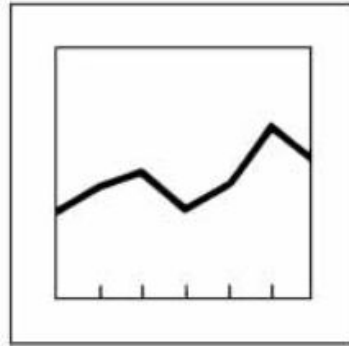
The bar chart



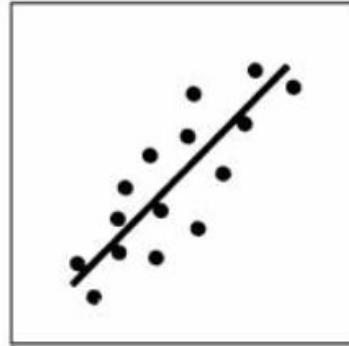
The column chart



The line chart



The dot chart



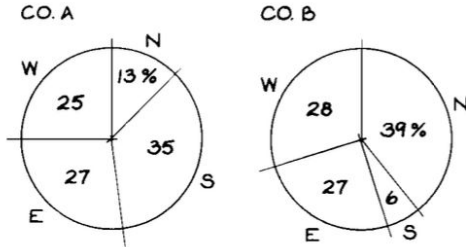
**Percentage of January Sales
by Region**

Charts and message

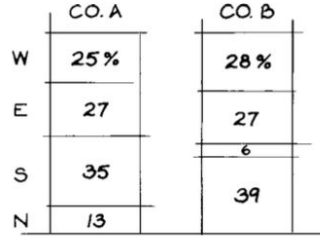
	<u>Co. A</u>	<u>Co. B</u>
North	13%	39%
South	35	6
East	27	27
West	25	28

Consider the table above. What charts emphasize what message?

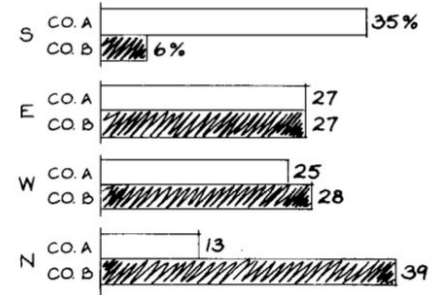
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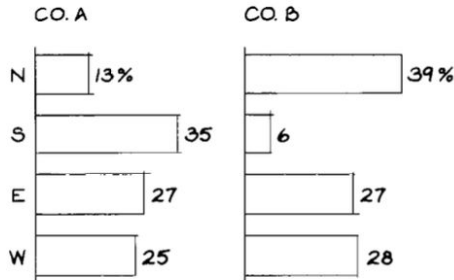
2



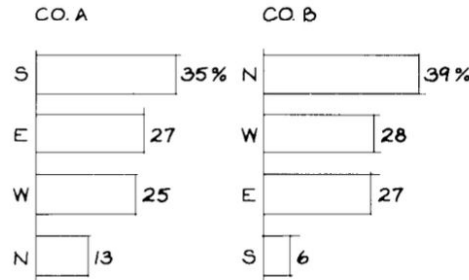
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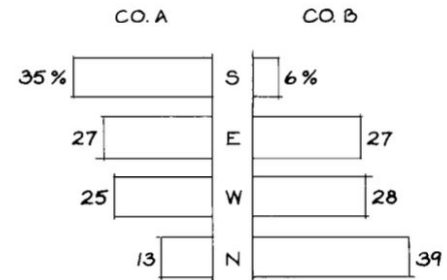
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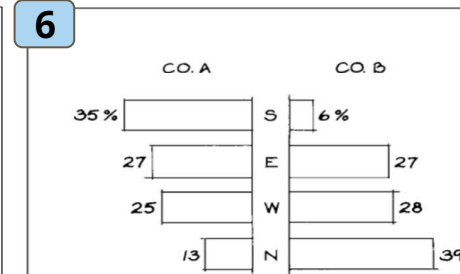
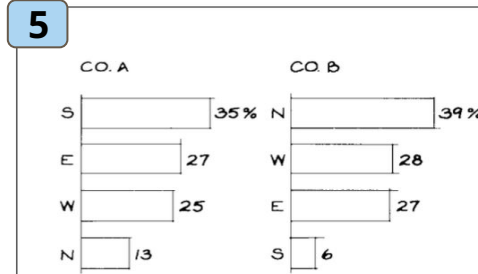
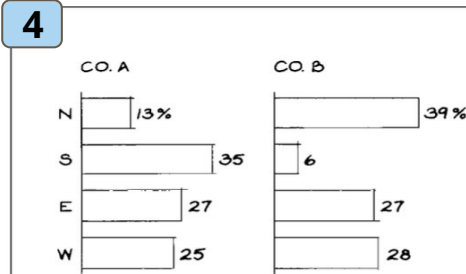
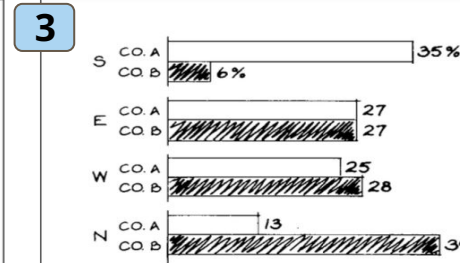
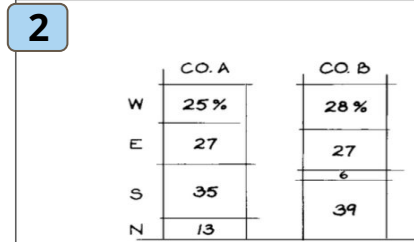
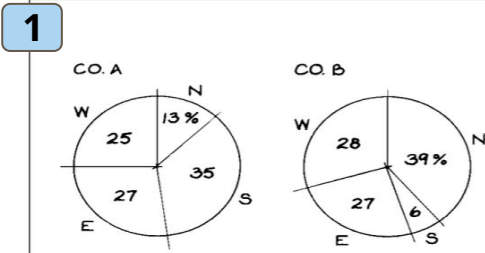


5



6





Which was the most useful to show the different mix of each company?

Which was the most useful to see the region of the companies' highest sales?

Which was the most useful to see the margin of the two companies' sales in each region?

Group activity

(4 mins per person)

1. Each member shows the table and the message created previously.
2. The other members help in the following ways:
 - a. Is there anything to add or delete in the table: labels or contexts?
 - b. Does the determined message capture the data enough?
 - c. What type of chart seems suitable for presenting the message?

The pie chart



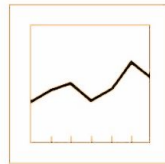
The bar chart



The column chart



The line chart



The dot chart



Debrief

What feedback was the most useful to you?

Was there any item added or deleted to the table? If so, what was it?

How did you choose the relevant chart? What was the reason of your choice?

Individual work

Complete writing following the rubric. You need 4 types of paragraph:

- (i) **Motivation**: Introduce the routine(s) of your choice and why it is meaningful to keep track of it/them.
- (ii) **Methodology**: Explain the device and methods used to collect the data, and the labels/contexts you chose to present together with the numbers.
- (iii) **Main body**: Discuss noticeable numbers, patterns, or correlations in text, referring to accompanied table(s) and graph(s). Justify your choice of graph.
- (iv) **Conclusion remarks**: 1-2 sentences of restatement and related thoughts.

The rubric

Format	File and page	File and format settings were perfectly followed: (i) Google doc; (ii) File name follows HS192_25-26_section##_roll-number_first-name; (iii) page size A4 with 1" margins
	Paragraphs	(i) No indentation for the first paragraph only & 0.5" indentation for the rest paragraphs, (ii) 1.5 spacing for all paragraphs, (iii) Times New Roman, font size 11 pt (13-15 pt for title)
	Writer/ course information	Writer/course information is presented well, right-aligned. Title captures the message of your data and interpretation.
Content	1. Motives & 2. Methods	At least one paragraph (approx. 3-5 sentences) introduces the routine(s) of your choice and why it is meaningful to keep track of it/them. At least one more paragraph (approx. 3-5 sentences) explains how you documented/accessed the number, and what labels/contexts were considered and selected.
	3. Main body (texts)	Paragraphs surrounding the graphics clearly deliver the main message(s) of the data and interpretation(s) well. A logical reason is given for why a specific type of chart is chosen/used.
	(graphics)	All table(s) and chart(s) are well organized with relevant caption at the correct location. They contain key information for interpreting the graphic, including (i) topic (& subtitle), (ii) unit(s) for numbers, (iii) labels/legends/categories.
	4. Conclusion	A short paragraph restate the message of the data, and conclude the essay with a prediction, suggestion, or any relevant piece of thoughts.

Individual work

Takes time to make a story on your own.

- (i) **Motivation** & (ii) **Methodology**: Clarify essential information compactly and clearly.
- (iii) **Main body**: The number of paragraphs match the number of numbers/patterns/correlations you found. Each paragraph will typically begin with a topic sentence and be followed by detailed expression referring to a table and/or a graph.
- (iv) **Conclusion remarks**: Keep it simple as an outro.

Next class

Bring your draft and a writing device for feedback session!